



Lynx lining Veronese's portrait of Countess Livia da Porto re-creates the depth of her lynx fur-lined robe. Over her arm is a *zibellino* – an Italian accessory made from the whole skin of a marten or mink, which was popular around 1551, the date of this painting.

Pearl necklace

Layers of bright feathers

Lynx fur lining

Girl dressed in floor-length robe similar to her mother's

Satin coat with embroidery



Gold earring

Cloak worn sideways, also popular in Europe



European jug

Fabric woven with gold

Deep pleats of silk and gold textiles



Many ostrich feathers

Hairnet and cap

Gold neck chokers and chains

Sleeve slit at elbow and panned to show off fine linen shirt

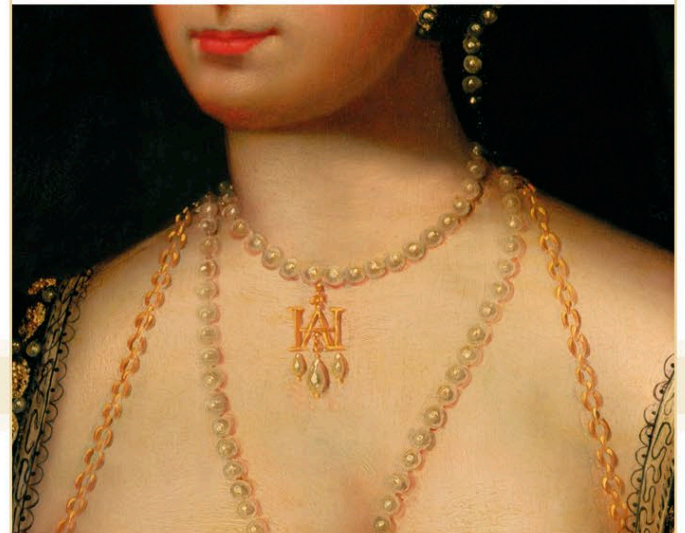
Large, tablet-woven silk and gold girdle

Lapdog for warmth, status, and company

New World feathers Indigenous Americans had ways of making intricate pictures and clothing, such as capes, using native feathers. Colonists brought these ideas and materials to Europe and used them in new styles of adornment.

Ostrich feathers No expense is spared in the Duchess of Saxony's 1515 ensemble, recorded by Cranach the Elder. African ostrich feathers adorn her hat, heavy gold necklaces with black diamonds crowd her neck, and gold is used wherever possible on her gown.

PEARLS



For the aristocracy, pearls were the most favoured jewel during this period. Women wore long strands as necklaces, worked them into their hair, and embroidered them into clothing. Men also wore earrings, brooches, hatpins, and other pearl adornments. Religious vestments incorporated the splendid lustre of pearls. They were even crushed in cosmetic recipes to beautify the skin.

Pearls were sourced laboriously from saltwater oysters around India and Arabia. Their mysterious appearance made them highly valuable, with irregular shapes set into great pendants.